

Skin Disease Reference Guide (Educational)

Vitiligo

Description: Loss of skin pigment.

Causes: Autoimmune/genetic.

Symptoms: White patches.

Common treatments: Topical corticosteroids, calcineurin inhibitors, phototherapy; dermatologist evaluation.

Notes: Generally harmless but affects appearance.

Disclaimer: Educational information only. Treatment depends on individual evaluation by a qualified clinician.

Lichen Planus

Description: Inflammatory skin disorder.

Causes: Immune-mediated.

Symptoms: Purple itchy flat bumps.

Common treatments: Topical steroids, antihistamines; severe cases may need systemic therapy.

Notes: May recur.

Disclaimer: Educational information only. Treatment depends on individual evaluation by a qualified clinician.

Psoriasis

Description: Chronic autoimmune skin disease.

Causes: Immune dysfunction.

Symptoms: Red plaques with silvery scales.

Common treatments: Topical corticosteroids, vitamin D analogs, phototherapy, biologics.

Notes: Chronic with flares.

Disclaimer: Educational information only. Treatment depends on individual evaluation by a qualified clinician.

Tinea Versicolor

Description: Superficial fungal infection.

Causes: Malassezia yeast overgrowth.

Symptoms: Light/dark scaly patches.

Common treatments: Ketoconazole or selenium sulfide shampoos; antifungals.

Notes: Common in humid climates.

Disclaimer: Educational information only. Treatment depends on individual evaluation by a qualified clinician.

Infestations & Bites

Description: Skin reactions from insects/mites.

Causes: Parasites or insect bites.

Symptoms: Itching, redness.

Common treatments: Permethrin for scabies when indicated; symptomatic care.

Notes: Treat contacts if scabies.

***Disclaimer:** Educational information only. Treatment depends on individual evaluation by a qualified clinician.*

Basal Cell Carcinoma (BCC)

Description: Most common skin cancer.

Causes: UV exposure.

Symptoms: Slow-growing pearly lesion.

Common treatments: Usually surgical removal; dermatologist referral.

Notes: Rarely spreads.

***Disclaimer:** Educational information only. Treatment depends on individual evaluation by a qualified clinician.*

Acne

Description: Inflammation of hair follicles.

Causes: Hormones, oil, bacteria.

Symptoms: Pimples, blackheads.

Common treatments: Benzoyl peroxide, topical retinoids, antibiotics when appropriate.

Notes: Avoid picking lesions.

***Disclaimer:** Educational information only. Treatment depends on individual evaluation by a qualified clinician.*

Actinic Keratosis (AK)

Description: Precancerous sun-damage lesion.

Causes: Chronic UV exposure.

Symptoms: Rough scaly patches.

Common treatments: Cryotherapy, topical fluorouracil or imiquimod.

Notes: Requires monitoring.

***Disclaimer:** Educational information only. Treatment depends on individual evaluation by a qualified clinician.*

Nevus (NEV)

Description: Common mole.

Causes: Benign melanocyte growth.

Symptoms: Brown/black spots.

Common treatments: Usually no treatment; monitor ABCDE changes.

Notes: Dermatology review if changing.

***Disclaimer:** Educational information only. Treatment depends on individual evaluation by a qualified clinician.*

Benign Keratosis (BKL/BKI)

Description: Benign skin growth.

Causes: Age-related.

Symptoms: Waxy brown growths.

Common treatments: Usually no treatment; removal if symptomatic.

Notes: Not cancerous.

Disclaimer: Educational information only. Treatment depends on individual evaluation by a qualified clinician.